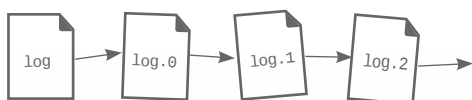


Working with Logrotate in Linux

Logrotate is a UNIX tool that comes in handy to automate log rotation in Linux. It is very helpful for the administrators managing any UNIX-like systems. This article describes how to use logrotate in Linux.



If logrotate is not already installed, use the appropriate package managers that your OS supports to install it.

In Ubuntu, use *apt-get*:

```
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install -y logrotate
```

In CentOS/RHEL, use *yum*:

```
sudo yum update
sudo yum install -y logrotate
```

To check how to use logrotate, run *--help*:

```
logrotate --help
```

Configuration and usage

Logrotate's default configuration is defined in */etc/logrotate.conf*. This should look something like what's given below:

```
[root@ci-01 ~]# cat /etc/logrotate.conf
# see "man logrotate" for details
# rotate log files weekly
weekly
# keep 4 weeks worth of backlogs
rotate 4
# create new (empty) log files after rotating old ones
create
# use date as a suffix of the rotated file
dateext
# uncomment this if you want your log files compressed
#compress
# RPM packages drop log rotation information into this
directory
include /etc/logrotate.d
# system-specific logs may be also be configured here.
```

The line *include /etc/logrotate.d* in the above *config* file makes it possible to include all the user created *config* files



Log files keep growing as and when events occur. These files need to be kept in check for growth in size, the removal of logs, etc. To automate this common process, logrotate comes into the picture.

Installation

To check whether logrotate is already installed in your system, you can try the command *logrotate --version*. It should list something like this:

```
[root@ci-01 ~]# logrotate --version
logrotate 3.14.0
Default mail command: /bin/mail
Default compress command: /bin/gzip
Default uncompress command: /bin/gunzip
Default compress extension: .gz
Default state file path: /var/lib/logrotate/logrotate.status
ACL support: yes
SELinux support: yes
```